

Instructor: Date:

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Let's Start!

Do you have anything to declare? It's time to clear customs.



Learning Outcome

Accurately use information involving apologies, thanks, suggestions and invitations in communicative situations.

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about air travel.
- I can make and respond to requests.
- I can ask someone to repeat.

Ask your partner:

- What personal items do you take with you when you travel?
- What kind of requests do you hear when you travel?





Let's Explore!

The **customs officer*** inspects Vanessa's bag. Does she have to fill out a **declaration form****? Let's find out.

* A "customs officer" is a person who inspects travelers' luggage.

** You use a "declaration form" to fill in the value of the goods you are carrying with you.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

Customs: Hello. Where are you coming from?
Vanessa: Boston.
Customs: Where are you going?
Vanessa: Mexico.
Customs: Where are you staying?
Vanessa: At the Hilton.
Customs: Do you have anything to declare?
Vanessa: Well, I bought gifts at the duty-free ...
Customs: Can you give me your customs declaration form, please?
Vanessa: Sure.
Customs: Hmmmm ... Do you have food? Food is restricted.
Vanessa: Oh, I had a meal in the airport.
Customs: Pardon me? Could you repeat that, please?
Vanessa: I ate earlier ...
Customs: Ma'am, do you have any food with you?
Vanessa: Yes, some cheese ...
Customs: I can't let you through, sorry. I have to inspect your bags. This way to inspection.

**Let's Practice!**

I can't let you through, sorry. You have to complete this exercise first.

Instructions: Use the words from the word bank to correctly complete the sentences.

Word Bank

bag / pass / gave me / passport / inspection area
Wood / give me / Could / inspector area

1. Can you _____ your customs declaration form, please?
2. _____ you come this way, please?
3. Would you please open your _____?
4. Could you bring your bag to the _____, please?
5. Can you write your name and _____ number, please?

**Let's Practice!**

Are you looking carefully? Can you spot the mistakes?

Instructions: Find and fix the mistake. Each sentence has 1 mistake.

1. Pardon my?
2. Could I repeat that, please?
3. Sorry? I didn't catch this.
4. You name is Zara?
5. Now, Sara.





Extension Activity

Let's role play!

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Read each role card below.
- Choose one role.
- Practice the situation with your partner.
- Switch roles and practice again.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I ask questions as a customs officer.

☐
☐

I answer questions as a traveler.

☐
☐

I ask someone to repeat their questions.

☐
☐

Role 1:	You are a customs officer. Ask the traveler 3 questions. For example: <i>Where are you staying? Where are you coming from? Do you have anything to declare?</i> You have to inspect their bag.
Role 2:	You are a traveler. You answer the customs officer's questions. You bought something at the duty-free. The officer wants to inspect your bag. Ask him/her to repeat.



Target Words

- **to stay** (verb): where you will be living
e.g. Where are you staying?
- **restricted** (adjective): banned; you can't have it
e.g. Do you have any restricted items?
- **to declare** (verb): to officially say the value of items you have
e.g. Do you have anything to declare?
- **duty-free shop** (noun): a store that sells goods tax-free to travelers who are leaving the country
e.g. I always shop at the duty-free shop.
- **inspection** (noun): the act of checking carefully
e.g. Please bring your bag for inspection.
- **to inspect** (verb): to check carefully, usually by an official
e.g. I have to inspect your bags.



Learning Points

Asking to Repeat

Use these expressions to ask a person to repeat what they said. You ask a person to repeat, to clarify or confirm what you hear.

Asking a person to repeat:

Could you repeat that, please?

What was that?

Sorry? I didn't catch that.

Michael: I am lost!

Clerk: What was that?

Michael: I'm lost!

Remember: If you ask a yes/no question, use rising intonation.

Examples:

• **Sara:** My name is Sara.

Boss: Is your name Zara?

Sara: No, it's Sara.

Making and Responding to Requests

You can use phrases that include modals to make and respond to requests:

Making a Request	<i>Could you ... ?</i> <i>Can you ... ?</i> <i>Would you mind ... ?</i>
Responding to a Request	<i>Sure. No problem.</i> <i>I'd love to.</i> <i>Yes, no problem.</i> <i>Sorry, I can't.</i> <i>I'm sorry, I can't.</i>

Examples:

• **Customs Officer:** Can you give me your customs declaration form, please?

Vanessa: Sure.

• **Sally:** Would you mind if I sat beside you?

John: No, please join me!

